DMC course: Week 3

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Homework

1. Watch *The Matrix* movie, written and directed by the Wachowskis, 2h16m

- $3.99 to rent on YouTube. Need to create a free YouTube login.
- $3.99 to rent, $14.99 to buy on Amazon Prime Video. Need an Amazon Prime account.



2. Read the essay The Comfortable Prison: The Matrix and the Philosophers

3. Read the essay No One Is Coming: The Matrix and the Rest of Us

Questions to Guide Reflection

Questions in Preface Section on *The Matrix* , Analysis of Societal Control)

- *Who or what is controlling society?*
- *How is it being controlled?*

Questions in The Comfortable Prison: The Matrix and the Philosophers

- Where does the film fit in our arc?
- Who or what is controlling society, and how?
- What does defiance look like when control no longer feels like control?
- Am I contributing to, or being swept up in, our collectively "checking out"?

- Do those who would give up essential Freedom, to purchase a little temporary Comfort, deserve either Freedom or Comfort?
- If there is no red pill, what are the rest of us supposed to do?
- Baudrillard says there is no "real world" to wake up into. Is he right, or is there still something real underneath the simulation?
- The film keeps Plato's structure of a real world behind the illusion. Is that a flaw, as Baudrillard thought, or a strength?
- Is Deleuze's picture of control, modulation without walls, a better description of our world than Orwell's Big Brother? Or do we live with both?

Questions in No One Is Coming: The Matrix and the Rest of Us

- If there is no red pill, what are the rest of us supposed to do?
- In all of these stories, isn't the essence of the struggle maintaining, or finding, one's own humanity?
- **Fear or desire?** Which controls you more these days: the news that frightens you, or the screens that please you? Can you tell them apart?
- **Your own Cypher moments.** When have you chosen the comfortable version of things, knowing it wasn't quite real? Was that always a bad choice?
- **What keeps you human?** What do you do, or refuse to do, that a system built to predict and please you would have trouble absorbing?
- **Waiting for a savior.** Do you find yourself hoping for a leader, a technology, or an event that will fix things? What would it mean to give up that hope without giving up?
- **Circuit breakers.** What are yours? A walk without your phone, a conversation with someone who disagrees with you, a book nobody recommended?

Week3 Class Presentation

- links will be provide after class is held